ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 2

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 100

Marking guideline for the Academic Central NC(V) Level 2 English First Additional Language practice exam.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 2. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training marking guideline.

How to mark: each ✓ is one mark. Accept answers in the student's own words if the meaning is correct. Do not penalise spelling in Section A unless the meaning is lost. Section D is marked with the rubric at the end of this memo.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

1.1 At Mokoena Electrical ✓ (1)

1.2 He had passed his college practicals with high marks ✓ (1)

1.3 Disappointed ✓ – "disappointed" ✓ (accept "I wanted to show him what I could do" for the reason, but the quote must be ONE word) (2)

1.4 He switched off the main switch ✓; he locked it ✓; he hung a warning sign on it ✓ (also accept: tested the circuit with a voltage tester) (3)

1.5 A switch may be faulty or wrongly labelled ✓, so the only way to be sure that there is no power is to test it ✓. (2)

1.6 He worked on a circuit that was labelled wrongly ✓ and was nearly killed / badly hurt ✓. (2)

1.7 Any THREE: speaking politely to customers ✓; explaining problems in simple words ✓; writing a clear job card ✓; being on time (3)

1.8 So that the office can invoice the customer correctly ✓ and there is a record of the work done ✓. (2)

1.9 The company is known by the way its workers behave ✓; if workers are late or unprofessional, customers will think badly of the company ✓. (2)

1.10 He did not shout but calmly explained that the customer was waiting ✓. He is calm / patient / respectful but firm ✓✓. (3)

1.11 B ✓ (1)

1.12 To show Sizwe that he understood the correct, safe procedure ✓ before working, so that mistakes could be corrected ✓. (2)

1.13 TRUE ✓ – "Good. Now you are starting to become an electrician." ✓ (2)

1.14 His qualification helped him to get the job ✓, but his success will depend on experience, working safely and respecting others ✓. (2)

1.15 Open answer: YES/NO with TWO sensible reasons, e.g. he trains apprentices patiently; he cares about safety ✓✓ (2)

[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Any SEVEN points in full sentences (1 mark each), plus up to 3 marks for language (full sentences, own words, within the word limit, correct spelling and punctuation):

1. Always wear overalls and safety boots. ✓
2. Remove rings, watches and chains before working. ✓
3. Never work on a live circuit. ✓
4. Switch off and test before you start. ✓
5. Check tools and report damaged ones. ✓
6. Keep your workbench clean. ✓
7. Do not eat or drink near the equipment. ✓
8. Report every accident to the lecturer immediately. ✓

Content: any SEVEN ✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ (7) Language ✓✓✓ (3). Deduct 1 mark if longer than 70 words or if the word count is missing. (10)

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

3.1 The circuit was tested ✓ by Sizwe ✓. (2)

3.2 He said that ✓ I would not touch a single wire ✓ that day ✓. (3)

3.3 I will follow Sizwe from one job to the next. ✓ (1)

3.4 (a) electricians ✓ (b) families ✓ (c) switches ✓ (3)

3.5 (a) unqualified ✓ (b) impolite / rude ✓ (2)

3.6 explanation ✓ (1)

3.7 The writer was late because he missed his taxi. ✓ (1)

3.8 (a) Sizwe has fifteen years of experience. ✓ (b) The customers were waiting. ✓ (2)

3.9 adverb ✓ (1)

3.10 "Where is the voltage tester?" ✓ asked ✓ the apprentice. ✓ (capital letter and question mark; inverted commas; full stop) (3)

3.11 (a) there ✓ (b) accept ✓ (2)

3.12 Any correct sentence, e.g. "Wear safety equipment, e.g. boots and gloves." ✓ (1)

3.13 To learn how to do a new job / to learn the basic skills and procedures of a new workplace ✓✓ (2)

3.14 Neither did the writer touch a wire, nor did Sizwe let him. / Neither the writer touched a wire nor did Sizwe let him. ✓ (accept any grammatically correct version) (1)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING – RUBRICS

Essay (20)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content and planning (12)	10–12: original, relevant, well-developed ideas; strong introduction and conclusion	7–9: relevant ideas with good detail	5–6: mostly relevant, some detail	0–4: few ideas, often off the topic
Language, style and editing (6)	6: varied vocabulary and sentences; very few errors	4–5: good vocabulary, few errors	3: simple but clear; some errors	0–2: many errors; meaning unclear
Structure (2)	2: clear paragraphs, logical order, correct length		0–1: poor paragraphing or far too short / long	

Transactional text (15)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content, planning and format (9)	8–9: all requirements covered; correct format; correct register	6–7: most requirements; format mostly correct	4–5: some requirements; format partly correct	0–3: task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (6)	6: very few errors	4–5: few errors	3: some errors	0–2: many errors

QUESTION 4

4.1 Narrative: clear setting, a problem or event, the lesson learnt and why it matters. Past tense used consistently. [20]

4.2 Argumentative / discursive: clear opinion, at least three reasons with examples (e.g. workshop, road, workplace), a conclusion. [20]

4.3 The job described clearly; reasons for the choice; a realistic plan (qualifications, experience, steps). [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5

5.1 **Formal letter** – sender's address and date; recipient's address (Mr Mokoena, Mokoena Electrical, 14 Church Street, Polokwane); "Dear Mr Mokoena"; subject line (e.g. APPLICATION FOR AN APPRENTICESHIP); body: qualification, skills, why this company; "Yours faithfully / sincerely", signature and full name. [15]

5.2 **E-mail** – To, From (optional), Subject, greeting; apology, reason (taxi strike), plan to prevent it (leave earlier, alternative transport); polite closing and name. [15]

5.3 **Memorandum** – MEMORANDUM heading; To, From, Date, Subject; short, clear points about the new rules and when they apply; name / initials of the sender. [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE